

Experience prototyping with zoning mock-ups

What this tool produces · *Physical, life-size simulations of proposed spatial footprints or building volumes, coupled with direct observational data on how people react to the new constraints.*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Regulation

Spatial

Social / User

Preparing the workshop · *Experience prototyping with zoning mock-ups*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Why this tool matters

Pulling abstract legal codes down from the statute books and drawing them onto the dirt, allowing citizens to judge the law with their own bodies.

Evidence we produce

Physical, life-size simulations of proposed spatial footprints or building volumes, coupled with direct observational data on how people react to the new constraints.

Duration & Material

Duration · 2 to 3 days for construction and testing

Material · Marking tape, cardboard, PVC pipes, temporary building materials, feedback forms

Reference case

The Pop-up Town Hall project temporarily deployed flexible, life-size carbon fiber structures in underutilized spaces across New York, Berlin, and Mumbai. This experience prototyping provided a physical platform for citizens, scholars, and planners to engage directly with experimental ideas and collaboratively explore the future dimensions of urban spaces before permanent structures were built.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Three scenario mock-ups · A · B · C

Duration
2 to 3 days for construction and testing

Scenario A

Current zoning

3D / plan mock-up

Pros

Cons

Open question

Scenario B

Mixed-use proposal

3D / plan mock-up

Pros

Cons

Open question

Scenario C

Bold rezone

3D / plan mock-up

Pros

Cons

Open question

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.